
Identification
Records identified from our own searching (n = 1009)
Embase, 15 Oct 2026: 710 hits, 659 article records and 51 registry records exported
CENTRAL, 15 Oct 2026: 460 exported, 200 not already in Embase
Web of Science, 16 Oct 2026: 317 exported, 99 in neither other database
PubMed anchor searches for the dual and triple agonists: 156, 95 and 13 PMIDs
Separate inflow, not from our searching
Mono agonist comparator trials adopted from two published systematic reviews: Alrasheed 2026, 40 RCTs; Ren 2025, 52 RCTs.
Their screening was performed by other groups and is inherited, so these records do not pass through the stages below. Re-screened against this review's criteria at extraction.
Screening
Records screened, title and abstract (n = 1009)
Three pools screened on different days by two independent reviewers with a third adjudicating: pool 1, the 659 Embase articles; pool 2, 251 registry and CENTRAL only records; pool 3, 99 Web of Science records.
Cohen kappa 0.649 (pool 1) and 0.556 (pool 2).
Records excluded (n = 433)
Pool 1 after the criteria v2 rescreen of its v1 exclusions: 297 (24 of 321 rescued).
Pool 2: 66. Pool 3: 70.
Records sought for full text (n = 576)
Pool 1: 362. Pool 2: 185. Pool 3: 29.
Not assessed (n = 23)
No text obtainable: 3, listed with reasons.
Already held in the master under another record: 20.
Eligibility
Records assessed at full text (n = 553)
Raw agreement 409 of 556, Cohen kappa 0.16, low because the marginals are extremely unbalanced and reported as such. All 149 disagreements adjudicated, 51 to include and 98 to exclude.
Records excluded (n = 113)
Design, population, intervention, outcome or timing criterion not met.
Records included, grouped into studies (n = 340)
440 included records grouped by DOI, title and registry identifier, so one study with a conference abstract, a register entry and a full text is one group.
Included
Studies contributing to the synthesis (n = 83 groups)
524 contrasts over 76 trials or trial analyses; groups can share a trial. 486 convertible to the percent change scale, 38 not, for want of a printed baseline denominator. Risk of bias assessed for 77 records.
Studies closed without contributing (n = 257)
No recoverable variance, closed by the deterministic scan: 104.
No recoverable variance on reading: 84.
Eligibility failure visible only at extraction, including three data integrity refusals: 37.
Molecule outside the admitted classes: 5. Registered without posted results: 11.
Held for a Director decision on population or co formulation: 16.
adopted comparator trials, re-screened at extraction